Alexandru-Ionut Blanaru

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EDUCATION

London School of Economics and Political Science Sep 2024 - Jun 2027

BSc Politics and Economics - Predicted Grade: First Class

1st-year modules: Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Quantitative Methods, Political Philosophy, Political Science

'Andrei Șaguna' High School Sep 2020 - Jun 2024

Natural Sciences - Grade: 9.72/10 (First Class)

Romanian Baccalaureate (10 Romanian Literature, 10 Mathematics, 9.95 Chemistry)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Roland Berger - Strategy Workshop Dec 2024

- Gained insights into strategic consultancy via a walkthrough of results from a real-world project advising a fashion company on entering the Romanian market
- Collaborated in a team to clarify key strategic questions related to the current economic environment in Romania

J.P. Morgan Asset Management - Virtual Experience Sep 2024

- Developed 2 virtual portfolios: $1.25 million for a conservative client and $1,250 for a risk-tolerant client
- Executed quantitative and fundamental analyses for publicly listed companies with an average market capitalisation of $300 billion, recommending a low-risk portfolio with significant allocations to cash, real estate, inflation-linked bonds, and IG bonds, and a high-risk portfolio heavily invested in equities

Fidelity International - Virtual Experience Aug 2024

- Conducted fundamental analysis of stocks and bonds, focusing on cash flow and growth potential
- Created portfolios with a Sharpe Ratio of 1.73 using Excel's Solver, outperforming the S&P 500's 0.98

Romanian Commercial Bank (Erste Group) - Internship Aug 2023

- Took part in presentations about the bank's organisational structure, credit system, and products
- Engaged in an activity to persuade a hypothetical client to purchase an Income Protection Insurance product

Schaeffler - Management Division Internship Mar 2023

- Shadowed professionals analysing KPIs and optimising processes, including programmes to improve workspace flow and productivity, contributing to the company's €16 billion revenue.

VOLUNTARY EXPERIENCE

TeachAS - Chemistry Mentor Sep 2022 - Jun 2023

- Helped establish a student-led programme that provided support to 140 fellow students
- Secured £4,000 in local authority funding, enabling the programme's county-wide expansion

EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

National Space Society - Space Settlement Contest Jan - Mar 2023

- Worked alongside team members with varying academic interests to design a spaceship capable of sustaining life

Chemistry Olympiad - Qualified for National Stages Apr 2022 & Apr 2023

- Developed strong adaptability during intense practical lab sessions with rapidly changing conditions

International Chemistry Tournament Aug 2022

- Led a team through 5 days of debates on solutions to complex problems, achieving 6th place overall

International Scientific Tournament Mar 2022

- Achieved 3rd place as a team for innovative research paper solutions to challenging open-ended scientific questions, such as terraforming Mars

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

- **Certifications**: Fixed Income Fundamentals (CFI), M&A Finance Accelerator (AmplifyME), Fundamentals of Quantitative Modelling - Wharton School (Coursera)
- **Computer**: Excel (Advanced), PowerPoint (Advanced), Word (Advanced)
- **Languages**: Romanian (native) and English (CAE level C2)
- **Societies**: Marshall Finance Group (Equity Research Analyst), LSE Business & Investment Group, LSE Central Banking Society
- **Interests**: Reading about world events, sports (tennis and skiing), Italian Opera (e.g. Puccinian verismo-style compositions)